



SEAT OF
JUSTICE: The
Supreme Court

The Federal WAY FORWARD

THE UNION OF A STRONG CENTRE
AND WEAK STATES HAS NOT WORKED.
ONLY STRONG, SELF-RELIANT
STATES WILL MAKE A UNITED INDIA.

BY FALI S. NARIMAN

There was great political upheaval when the Constituent Assembly met 60 years ago to draft a written Constitution for India. The trauma of Partition and the carnage it brought in its wake set the tone for the deliberations: the overriding concern was for the "integrity of India": which came to be expressed in the final draft Constitution (up front, in the Preamble). Consensus was easily achieved in the provision for a common citizenship, but as to what should be the common language, there was much disputation. With more than 30 Indian languages competing for recognition, the Constituent Assembly ultimately agreed to Hindi and English as the two official languages of the Union, symbolic of One India. Then, a provision for an